Mays Business School

Marketing

MKTG 323 Syllabus

Section 500 (53746)
Marketing Research
Spring 2026 - College Station

Course Information

Meeting Times: Meeting Type: LEC
Meeting Days: TR
Start Time: 1:15PM
End Time: 2:30PM
Start Date: 01/12/2026
End Date: 05/05/2026
Meeting Location: WCBA 205

Credit Hours: 3

Instructor Details

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Teaching Assistant

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Catalog Description

Marketing Research. (3-0). Credit 3. Nature and uses of marketing research in business; methods of collecting, analyzing and interpreting data needed for business decisions, with specific application to problems in marketing. Prerequisites: MKTG 321; BUSN 203 or STAT 211.

Course Prerequisites

Prerequisite/Corequisite(s): MKTG 321; BUSN 203 or STAT 211.

Special Course Designation

None

Course Learning Outcomes

Marketing 323 is designed to familiarize students with the field of marketing research and its application to real-world business decision making. Through coursework and a research project, students develop the ability to identify relevant information sources, design and implement appropriate research approaches, summarize, analyze, and interpret data, and translate research findings into actionable marketing insights.

Textbook and/or Resource Materials

This material Is: Recommended

Essentials of Marketing Research

ISBN: 9781260260465

Authors: Joseph Hair

Notes:

The recommended textbook complements the course content and serves as a valuable resource. Any recent edition of the book works well.

Grading Policy

Exams

Exam 1 (Midterm): 100 points

Exam 2 (Final Exam): 100 points

Group Research Project

Project Part 1: Proposal Presentation – 50 points

Project Part 2: Secondary & Qualitative Presentation – 100 points

Project Part 3: Final Presentation – 150 points

Individual Assignments

Individual Assignemtns and in-class Excel Exercises – 100 points

Class Participation

Attendance and Participation – 50 points

Total: 650 points

Grading Scale:

A: 90–100%

B: 80–89%

C: 70–79%

D: 60–69%

F: Below 60%

Note: Grades may be curved at the instructor's discretion.

Learning Activities

RESEARCH PROJECT

You will form groups of **4–5 members**. You may choose to form your own group, or I can assist you in doing so. If you submit a group request with fewer than four members, your group may be adjusted to meet the required size.

The purpose of the research project is to develop skills required to effectively navigate the key stages of the marketing research process. You will work on a marketing research project for a product or service. Guidelines for selecting a suitable product or service will be provided on the course website. You will assume the role of marketing researchers for an existing product or service, or one you are considering launching.

To ensure steady progress throughout the semester, the project is divided into multiple parts with specific deliverables. A detailed description of the project requirements and evaluation criteria will be posted on the course website.

Several class sessions will be designated as **Teamwork Days**. Students are expected to come prepared and actively work with their teams during these sessions. Performance during Teamwork Days contributes to the **class participation grade**.

Students are expected to approach group work with the same level of professionalism expected in a workplace. All interactions—both within your group and with any external stakeholders—must be professional and respectful. Failure to adhere to these expectations may result in a reduction of participation points.

All graded project work must be completed **independently within your assigned team**. Using work completed by individuals outside your team is not permitted. This includes, but is not limited to, work obtained through conversations, messaging platforms, email, social media, tutoring websites, discussion forums, or similar sources.

Peer Evaluation

All group members are expected to contribute meaningfully to every phase of the project. At the end of the semester, students will complete confidential peer evaluations assessing each member's overall contribution. Peer evaluation scores will be used to adjust individual project grades and may also affect participation grades.

EXAMS

There will be a midterm exam and a final exam. They will cover material discussed in the class notes, class discussions, assignments, handouts, and any other content covered during class time. Unless explicitly permitted by the instructor, the use of generative AI tools or other unauthorized resources during exams is prohibited and constitutes academic misconduct.

INDIVIDUAL ASSIGNMENTS

In addition to the group project, students will complete **individual assignments**, including **in-class Excel exercises**, throughout the semester. These exercises are designed to develop applied data analysis skills covered in class.

In-class Excel exercises must be completed during the scheduled class period and generally **cannot be made up** without a University-approved excuse.

CLASS PARTICIPATION

Class participation is based on active engagement in lectures, in-class exercises, Teamwork Days, and presentation sessions. Attendance alone does not constitute participation. Additional details regarding participation expectations and grading criteria are provided below.

Late Work Policy

Work submitted by a student as makeup work for an excused absence is not considered late work and is exempt from the late work policy (Student Rule 7).

Course Specific Late Work Policy

Any work submitted after the stated deadline without an applicable University-approved excuse will receive a zero, in accordance with Student Rule 7.

Students with a University-approved excuse must submit documentation and coordinate a make-up within **one week of their documented return to class**. After this period, the missed activity will receive a zero and no further appeals will be considered.

Course Schedule

(Schedule subject to change. Any changes will be announced on Canvas.)

Tuesday, January 13
Introduction to Marketing Research; course overview; expectations; forming project teams.

Thursday, January 15
Research proposal and decision problems.

Tuesday, January 20
Team Work Day: Research proposal development.

Thursday, January 22
Project Part 1 – Research Proposal Presentations.

Tuesday, January 27
Secondary research and secondary data sources.

Thursday, January 29
Team Work Day: Secondary research.

Tuesday, February 3
Designing the research project.

Thursday, February 5
Team Work Day: Focus group design and practice.

Tuesday, February 10
Sampling and survey methods.

Thursday, February 12
Qualitative data analysis. *Conduct focus group discussions this week.*

Tuesday, February 17
Team Work Day: Coding focus group data.

Thursday, February 19
Project Part 2 – Secondary and Qualitative Research Presentations.

Tuesday, February 24
Measurement and scaling.

Thursday, February 26
Midterm preparation and practice questions. *(No in-class meeting.)*

Tuesday, March 3

Exam 1 – Midterm.

Thursday, March 5
Questionnaire design.

Tuesday, March 10

Spring Break – No class.

Thursday, March 12
Spring Break – No class.

Tuesday, March 17

Using Qualtrics and understanding data.

Thursday, March 19
Quantitative data analysis.

Tuesday, March 24

Quantitative data analysis and in-class Excel exercise.

Thursday, March 26
Quantitative data analysis and in-class Excel exercise.

Tuesday, March 31
Quantitative data analysis and in-class Excel exercise.

Thursday, April 2
Quantitative data analysis and in-class Excel exercise.

Tuesday, April 7
Team Work Day: Project data analysis.

Thursday, April 9
Team Work Day: Finalizing project analysis.

Tuesday, April 14
Final Project Presentations – Day 1.

Thursday, April 16
Final Project Presentations – Day 2.

Tuesday, April 21
No class – Muster.

Thursday, April 23
Final presentation wrap-up and final exam review. *Peer evaluations due.*

Tuesday, April 28
No class – Redefined Day (Friday schedule).

Final Exam Period

April 30 – May 5
Exam 2 – Final Exam (per University final exam schedule).

AI Statement

With the emergence of artificial intelligence (AI) technologies, the ways in which we define our creative processes continue to transform. AI generators are rapidly evolving from simple editing for grammatical errors and spelling mistakes (Grammarly, MS Word Spell Check) to sophisticated text production (ChatGPT, Google Bard, etc.), as well as image, computer code, and audio generation. The presence of such tools, however, does not replace our need to learn how to draft, revise, and reflect on texts, programs, drawings and how to exercise information literacy and personal responsibility in how we locate, evaluate, incorporate, and cite primary/ secondary sources. For example, the Association for Writing Across the Curriculum states the following: Writing to learn is an intellectual activity that is crucial to the cognitive and social development of learners and writers. This vital activity cannot be replaced by AI language generators (AWAC).

Engaging in the various aspects of creative pursuits (e.g., writing, coding, drawing) is critical to education in a broad sense. While AI technologies will continue shaping how we approach these creative tasks, the critical work of creativity relies on integrity, originality, and ethical conduct in regard to appropriate representation as an author or creator. Thus, submitting work with a significant percentage of AI-generated content, unless otherwise permitted, can be considered academic misconduct under Texas A&M University Student Rule 20. Students must therefore cite the use of Generative AI tools and document what they have contributed to an assignment.

Technology Support

Technology Services (IT) - Main Campus

Hours	24/7/365
Phone	(979) 845-8300

Email	helpdesk@tamu.edu
Help Desk Central	it.tamu.edu/help

Canvas LMS Technical Support

Hours	24/7/365
Phone	(877) 354-4821
Email	support@instructure.com

Accessing Canvas Support Within Canvas

- Click the **Help** button in the global navigation menu (far left) of any Canvas course.
- **Canvas Resources** are also linked on the **Home** page of each Canvas course.

College Policies

This section details college-level policies established by the Deans and Department Heads of Mays Business School.

Mays Food and Beverage Policy

Please follow the policy prohibiting food, tobacco products, and beverages except bottled water in classrooms. Animals are not permitted unless officially approved. Thank you for your cooperation.

Makeup Work Policy

Students will be excused from attending class on the day of a graded activity or when attendance contributes to a student's grade, for the reasons stated in Student Rule 7, or other reason deemed appropriate by the instructor.

Please refer to Student Rule 7 in its entirety for information about makeup work, including definitions, and related documentation and timelines.

Absences related to Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 may necessitate a period of more than 30 days for make-up work, and the timeframe for make-up work should be agreed upon by the student and instructor" (Student Rule 7, Section 7.4.1).

"The instructor is under no obligation to provide an opportunity for the student to make up work missed because of an unexcused absence" (Student Rule 7, Section 7.4.2).

Students who request an excused absence are expected to uphold the Aggie Honor Code and Student Conduct Code. (See Student Rule 24.)

Mays Statement on Outside Resources

Students must complete all graded work independently. For team-based assignments, work should be completed independently within your assigned team. Using work completed by someone else outside of your team or class is considered academic dishonesty.

This includes but is not limited to work obtained through face-to-face conversations, phone calls, text messages, instant messages, chats, Slack exchanges, emails, social media posts, tutoring sites, discussion forums, blogs, and similar platforms.

University Policies

This section outlines the university-level policies that must be included in each course syllabus. The TAMU Faculty Advisory Council established the wording of these policies.

Academic Integrity Statement and Policy

"An Aggie does not lie, cheat or steal, or tolerate those who do."

"Texas A&M University students are responsible for authenticating all work submitted to an instructor. If asked, students must be able to produce proof that the item submitted is indeed the work of that student. Students must keep appropriate records at all times. The inability to authenticate one's work, should the instructor request it, may be sufficient grounds to initiate an academic misconduct case" (Section 20.1.2.3, Student Rule 20).

You can learn more about the Aggie Honor System Office Rules and Procedures, academic integrity, and your rights and responsibilities at aggiehonor.tamu.edu.

University Attendance Policy

The university views class attendance and participation as an individual student responsibility. Students are expected to attend class and to complete all assignments.

Please refer to Student Rule 7 in its entirety for information about excused absences, including definitions, and related documentation and timelines.

Course Specific Attendance Policy

Throughout the semester, we will participate in small in-class exercises. These exercises will contribute to your participation grade; in other words, simply attending class will not earn you full credit. Please arrive on time and refrain from sleeping, reading newspapers, working on crosswords or Sudoku, sending text messages, playing mobile games or engaging in other distracting activities.
Your contribution in classes will be rewarded based on the following criteria:

- **No Credit:** Absent, partially absent, unprofessionally dressed, or engaged in distracting, disruptive, or unprofessional behavior.
- **Partial Credit:** Attended the entire class but did not make any contribution.
- **Full Credit:** Made meaningful contributions through activities such as asking or answering questions (verbally or via chat), making comments (verbally or via chat), and presenting breakout exercise summaries.

I have also scheduled a few class periods for you to work on your group project – **Teamwork Days. On Teamwork Days and Presentation Days, attendance will be mandatory.** Non-

University-approved absences on these mandatory days will result in **a deduction of 10 Class Participation Points** for each absence.

TEAMWORK DAYS
Teamwork days are required in-class workdays. These sessions should be used to obtain feedback from your instructor on all written and oral assignments before they are due. You will work on your group project and other assigned tasks with your teammates during these days. The instructor will be available to answer your questions.

Statement on the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA)

FERPA is a federal law designed to protect the privacy of educational records by limiting access to these records, to establish the right of students to inspect and review their educational records, and to provide guidelines for the correction of inaccurate and misleading data through informal and formal hearings.

Currently enrolled students wishing to withhold any or all directory information items can do so within howdy.tamu.edu using the Directory Information Withholding Form. The complete FERPA Notice to Students and the student records policy is available on the Office of the Registrar webpage.

Items that can never be identified as public information are a student's social security number, citizenship, gender, grades, GPR, or class schedule. All efforts will be made in this class to protect your privacy and to ensure confidential treatment of information associated with or generated by your participation in the class.

Directory items include name, UIN, local address, permanent address, email address, local telephone number, permanent telephone number, dates of attendance, program of study (college, major, campus), classification, previous institutions attended, degrees, honors and awards received, participation in officially recognized activities and sports, medical residence location, and medical residence specialization.

Notice of Nondiscrimination

Texas A&M University is committed to providing safe and non-discriminatory learning, living, and work environments for all members of the University community. The University provides equal opportunity to all employees, students, applicants for employment or admission, and the public, regardless of race, color, sex (including pregnancy and related conditions), religion, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, or veteran status.

Texas A&M University will promptly, thoroughly, and fairly investigate and resolve all complaints of discrimination, harassment (including sexual harassment), complicity, and related retaliation based on a protected class in accordance with System Regulation 08.01.01, University Rule 08.01.01.M1, Standard Administrative Procedure (SAP) 08.01.01.M1.01, and applicable federal and state laws. In accordance with Title IX and its implementing regulations, Texas A&M does not discriminate on the basis of sex in any educational program or activity, including admissions and employment.

The following person has been designated to handle inquiries and complaints regarding the non-discrimination policies: Jennifer M. Smith, TAMU Associate VP & Title IX Coordinator at YMCA Ste 108, College Station, TX 77843, 979-458-8407, or email civilrights@tamu.edu. For other reporting options, visit the U.S. Department of Education Office for Civil Rights Complaint Assessment System to locate the address and phone number of the office that serves your area, or call 1-800-421-3481.

Civil Rights, Free Speech, and Title IX Policies

Texas A&M University is committed to fostering a learning environment that is safe and productive for all. University policies and federal and state laws prohibit discrimination and harassment based on an individual's race, color, sex, (including pregnancy and related conditions), religion, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, veteran status, or any other legally protected characteristic. This includes forms of sex-based violence, such as sexual assault, sexual harassment, sexual exploitation, dating/domestic violence, and stalking.

Students can report discrimination/harassment, access supportive resources, or learn more about their options for resolving complaints on the University's Civil Rights & Title IX webpage.

Students should be aware that all university employees (except medical or mental health providers) are mandatory reporters, which means that if they observe, experience or become aware of an incident that they reasonably believe to be discrimination/harassment alleged to have been committed by or against a person who was a student or employee at the time of the incident, the employee must report the incident to the university.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) Policy

Texas A&M University is committed to providing equitable access to learning opportunities for all students. If you experience barriers to your education due to a disability or think you may have a disability, please contact the Disability Resources office on your campus (resources listed below). Disabilities may include, but are not limited to, attentional, learning, mental health, sensory, physical, or chronic health conditions. All students are encouraged to discuss their disability-related needs with Disability Resources and their instructors as soon as possible.

To request academic accommodations, contact the designated ADA office based on your location:

- Texas A&M University, College of Nursing, College of Dentistry, Irma Lerma Rangel College of Pharmacy College Station, College of Medicine, School of Public Health, Institute of Biosciences and Technology, EnMed Program, Bush School in Washington DC, Mays Business School – CityCentre, TAMU Engineering Academies, Texas A&M University Higher Education Center at McAllen and Texas A&M University at Galveston should contact Disability Resources at (979) 845-1637 or disability@tamu.edu.
- Texas A&M University School of Law should contact the Office of Student Affairs at (817) 212-4111 or law-disability@law.tamu.edu to request accommodations.

- Irma Lerma Rangel College of Pharmacy in Kingsville should contact the Disability Resource Center at Texas A&M University-Kingsville at (361) 593-3024 or drc.center@tamuk.edu to request accommodations.
- Texas A&M University College of Veterinary Medicine & Biomedical Sciences in Canyon should contact the Office of Student Accessibility at West Texas A&M University – Canyon at (806) 651-2335 or osa@wtamu.edu.

If you are experiencing difficulties with your approved accommodations, contact the office responsible for approving your accommodations or the Texas A&M ADA Coordinator Julie Kuder at ADA.Coordinator@tamu.edu or (979) 458-8407.

Pregnancy Accommodations

Texas A&M provides reasonable accommodations to students due to pregnancy and/or related conditions, such as childbirth, recovery, and lactation. Students should contact the University's Pregnancy Coordinator as soon as they become aware of the need for accommodation. Depending on the circumstances, accommodations could include extended time to complete assignments or exams, changes in course sequence, or modifications to the physical classroom environment.

Texas A&M will also allow a voluntary leave of absence, ensure the availability of lactation space, and maintain grievance procedures to provide for the prompt and equitable resolution of complaints of sex discrimination. For information regarding pregnancy accommodations, email TIX.Pregnancy@tamu.edu.

Statement on Mental Health and Wellness

Texas A&M University recognizes that mental health and wellness are critical factors influencing a student's academic success and overall wellbeing. Students are encouraged to engage in healthy self-care practices by utilizing the resources and services available through University Health Services. The TELUS Health Student Support app provides access to professional counseling in multiple languages anytime, anywhere by phone or chat, and the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline offers 24-hour emergency support at 988 or 988lifeline.org.

Texas A&M College Station

Students needing a listening ear can contact University Health Services at 979.458.4584. Call 911 or visit your nearest emergency room if you are currently experiencing a life-threatening situation or if your safety is at risk. 24-hour emergency help is also available through the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (988) or at 988lifeline.org.

Free Speech and Civil Discourse

Texas A&M recognizes that the pursuit of truth through open and robust discourse is critical to academic inquiry. However, as a community of scholars, the university has an aspirational expectation that such discourse will be conducted in accordance with Aggie Core Values. In this "marketplace of ideas," we encourage civil dialogue creating an environment that allows individuals to express their ideas and to have their ideas challenged in respectful and responsible ways. Students can learn more about Freedom of Expression and Free Speech on the University's website about the First Amendment.